Dan Dobrick

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Backend engineer with 10 years in Ruby on Rails, currently owning payments on Shopify's billing platform, where I design cross-team systems that reach every merchant. I've been a technical lead since my first engineering job, including rebuilding brightwheel's education product and building its Marketplace from scratch. I run several AI coding agents in parallel to ship more, sooner, without sacrificing quality.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Shopify

Senior Software Engineer — **Jun. 2024 – Present**

On a 7-engineer team running the billing platform that invoices and collects payment from every Shopify merchant ($7B/year), including PCI-scoped and internationally regulated payment flows. Own all payment methods and payment processing, including all India (INR) payments.

- Led cross-team delivery of on-session payments for hundreds of thousands of Indian merchants, cutting time-to-pay from 30 hours to 30 seconds and raising the payment success rate by 50%. Persuaded Razorpay to fix their token-authentication API instead of the redirect flow they'd recommended, which would have meant rework across 4 systems.
- Migrated $100M/month of usage-based billing across 2 services from integer to decimal precision with zero revenue impact, proving equivalence with a production shadow comparison before cutover and removing a micro-unit workaround from every API client.
- Designed and shipped the billing platform's public GraphQL API, replacing a legacy proxy for most merchants and enabling role-based billing permissions for multi-shop enterprise accounts.
- Tech lead for migrating Billing's card vault into the company-wide vault, the first step in retiring a legacy card-payment flow. Built the groundwork (gRPC client, Kafka consumers, Braintree/Stripe network tokens); when prototyping showed the vault design couldn't support high-profile, high-value edge cases, paused the migration and redesigned payment-method ownership with the vault team, which also eliminates copying it to each of a merchant's shops.
- Run 3–6 coding agents in parallel across 2–3 projects to increase my velocity, verifying each PR against production data before merge, per the agent guidance and PR workflow I helped write for the team.

brightwheel · early-education software

Staff Software Engineer — **Feb. 2020 – May 2024**

Promoted from Senior Software Engineer, Jan. 2023

- Led a 3-engineer team that rebuilt the education product from the ground up: designed and built the new system educators use to create lessons, migrated all customers from the legacy version while supporting both old and new lesson plans, and shipped on time despite substantially shifting requirements.
- Sole backend engineer on a greenfield Marketplace, from concept to launch, working directly with product and design. Built geocoding and location search on PostGIS.
- Designed the data model and API to integrate an acquired company's curriculum alongside existing learning features, and migrated its content.
- Designed and built the original greenfield "flexible form" product that powers daycare enrollment applications, on a Rails platform serving 250k RPM; the team has since extended it.
- Cut CI build times 90% for a Next.js codebase by optimizing its build and CircleCI pipelines.
- Set backend priorities, led design reviews, and mentored 3 engineers. Ran the system-design interview and gave feedback on its rubric and technical challenge.

- Investigated production database stalls and implemented statement timeouts to prevent them; mitigated card-testing attacks with IP blocking and AWS WAF rules.

Jellyvision · benefits decision-support software

Senior Software Engineer **Dec. 2016 – Feb. 2020**

Promoted from Software Engineer, Apr. 2019

- Co-owned the Ruby on Rails API behind ALEX, a conversational benefits counselor, handling up to 20M requests a day.
- Led a 3-person team that built a "doctor finder" feature from requirements, integrating third-party APIs. Mentored teammates in TypeScript on the Node and React stack.
- Migrated a page from an in-house, Angular-style framework to React, making it render 5x faster.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Ruby & Rails: Ruby, Ruby on Rails, Sidekiq, graphql-ruby, RSpec, Minitest, Sorbet

APIs & messaging: GraphQL, gRPC/protobuf, REST, Kafka, SQS

Data: PostgreSQL (PostGIS), MySQL, Redis, BigQuery, SQL

Payments & e-commerce: Stripe, Braintree, Razorpay, BigCommerce

Payments domain: PCI DSS, card vaulting, network tokenization, recurring & usage-based billing, invoicing

Infrastructure: Kubernetes, Docker, GCP, AWS, CircleCI

Monitoring: Datadog, New Relic, Grafana, Bugsnag

JavaScript: TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, React

AI tooling: parallel multi-agent workflows (pi, herdr); Claude, GPT, and other models chosen per task

EDUCATION

Loyola University Chicago — Master of Education (M.Ed.), 2015

University of California, Santa Cruz — BA, Mathematics, 2011

Dev Bootcamp — Immersive web development (Ruby on Rails), 2016